

AARON SCHERF

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WORK EXPERIENCE

U.S. Agency for International Development

06/2020 – 07/2025

Foreign Service Officer - Monitoring, Evaluation, Learning Team Lead (FS 3-5)
Kyiv, Ukraine

- Managed portfolio of 20 program evaluations, including leading design of a \$1.5M randomized control trial to evaluate impact and cost effectiveness of \$450M credit facilitation program for small farmers.
- Developed analytics system to track \$5Bn in electrical infrastructure support by administrative geography, enabling rapid repairs in response to Russian missile strikes and increased accountability.
- Supervised \$36M contract for monitoring, evaluation, and learning services, including developing new systems for performance tracking, strategy alignment, and context research.
- Managed inventories and asset databases for electrical infrastructure and humanitarian equipment across more than 16 projects.
- Co-created third-party monitoring system which conducted over 3,000 verification visits in a year.

U.S. Agency for International Development

06/2020 – 07/2025

Foreign Service Officer - Gender Equity and Program Design Officer (FS 4-9)
Bogotá, Colombia

- Led the design and context research for four programs in smallholder agriculture, environmental conservation, rural land titling, and indigenous civic society leadership.
- Developed system to process high-resolution drone imagery for land titling in flood-prone rural areas.
- Led country-level FY24 presidential budget request for \$413 million.
- Led collection of over 500 performance indicators across 32 development programs for annual report.

Monitoring and Evaluation Specialist (Visiting Fellow)

05/2019 – 07/2025

Monitoring and Evaluation Specialist (Visiting Fellow)
Pretoria, South Africa

- Revised evaluation methodology for 12 regional programs to improve validity of performance metrics.
- Authored 200-page regional Gender Analysis report for 7 countries, synthesizing research on conditions for women, people with disabilities, and LGBTQI+ persons in Southern Africa.

Bloomfield Community Empowerment Center

10/2015 – 05/2016

Economic Analyst
Macon

- Collected socioeconomic data on local neighborhood through census and tax assessor files.
- Developed neighborhood revitalization strategy centered on resident participation and presented to county commission.
- Presented research methodology and results of strategy at Clinton Global Initiative University 2016, under Commitment to Action “Collect to Connect: Bloomfield Community Asset Analysis”.

EDUCATION

Columbia University

- PhD in Sustainable Development
- New York, NY, USA • 08/2026 – Present

Georgia Institute of Technology

- Master of Science in Computer Science • GPA: 3.88
- Atlanta, GA, USA • 01/2022 – 12/2025

Indiana State University

- Master of Science in Mathematics • GPA: 3.85
- Terre Haute, IN, USA • 05/2021 – 05/2024
- Thesis: Novel Omnibus Normality Test and Power Comparison with the Shapiro-Wilk

University of California, Berkeley

- Master of Science in Development Practice • GPA: 3.94
- Berkeley, CA, USA • 07/2018 – 05/2020
- Thesis: Predicting the Yield of CIMMYT Wheat Genotypes via Remote Sensing and Machine Learning

Heidelberg University

- Master of Science (audited) in Economics
- Heidelberg, DE • 07/2017 – 06/2018

Mercer University

- Bachelor in Finance and Economics • GPA: 3.91
- Macon, GA, USA • 08/2013 – 05/2017
- Thesis: Analyzing Regional Economic Impacts of Syrian Refugee Crisis in Turkey

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

- Donald M. Payne Fellow (05/2017) — \$100,000 fellowship with USAID
- Fulbright Scholar (05/2017) — Research Fellow at ZEW / Heidelberg, DE
- Humanity in Action Senior Fellow (05/2017) — in partnership with Amnesty International
- Stamps Foundation Leadership Scholar (05/2013) — \$240,000 merit scholarship
- Payne International Development Fellow (Not specified) — \$90,000 Graduate Fellowship with USAID
- Fulbright Graduate Research Award (Not specified) — \$10,000 Research Grant and Cultural Exchange Program

RESEARCH PRESENTATIONS & PUBLICATIONS

- Applications of PCA for Mapping Regional Socioeconomic Vulnerability Indices (12/2019) — UC Berkeley: Data for Human Mobility Lab
- Integration Progress: Results from two Reallabor Surveys of Asylum Seekers (08/2018) — Centre for European Economic Research (ZEW) ([link](#))
- Gentrification or Revitalization? Ethical Investment in Urban Property Development (04/2017) — National Conference on Undergraduate Research
- Economic Impact Assessment of Historic Property Rehabilitation in Macon, GA (04/2017) — Society of Business, Industry, and Economics Conference
- “OurBlock” - Blockchain Based Property Registry for South African Land Reform (03/2017) — Harvard Social Entrepreneurship Pitch Competition
- “How to Kill a Microfinance Fund” – Analysis of Microcredit Policy in South Africa (10/2016) — Southern Conference Undergraduate Research Forum
- “Bloomfield 2020” – Neighborhood Economic Development Plan (04/2016) — Clinton Global Initiative University at Berkeley, CA
- Autonomous Drone Deployment Grid for Improved Wildfire Response in California (05/2020) — UC Berkeley: Innovations in Disaster Response Showcase
- The End of Schengen? Reforms to the Dublin Regulation and EU Asylum Policy (08/2017) — Humanity in Action International Conference in Strasbourg, FR

SKILLS

Computer Programming and Artificial Intelligence: Python, R, JavaScript, Stata, MatLab, Excel, Machine Learning, Natural Language Processing, Artificial Neural Networks

Applied Economic Research: GIS Analysis (ArcGIS / GEE), Applied Econometrics, Mathematical Statistics, Labor Economic Research, Applied Mathematics, Development Economics

Languages and Other: Spanish - Professional, German - Intermediate, Program Evaluation, Empirical Policy Analysis, Information Communications Technology

Computer Programming: Python, R, JavaScript

Data Engineering: SQL, Azure, GCP

Agentic AI: CrewAI, AutoGen

Natural Language Processing:

Data Visualization and Analysis: Tableau, PowerBI

Artificial Neural Networks: Machine Learning, Large Language Models

Cloud Architecture: GCP, Azure

RAG AI: LangChain

Google Earth Engine / GCP:

Data Collection & Processing: